Key to the Sixth House Lair

Dungeon Level 1

The entrance lies hidden beneath the Bitter Coast's swampy earth. A circular dam has been built to keep water from flowing into a small cave entrance on the ground in a small island. Upon approaching the cave mouth, the air grows thick with incense and decay. Strange symbols writhe at the edges of vision.

Wandering Monsters: Whenever the DM desires them to appear.

Roll	Encounter
1	Mudcrabs (2-4) — AC 13; HP 5; Atk +3 for 1d6+1
2	Scribs (2-4) — AC 13; HP 13; Atk +3 for 1d6+1
3	Shalk Beetle — AC 18; HP 13; Atk +3 for 1d6+1
4	Dreamer cultists (1-4) — AC 12; HP 16; Atk +3 for 1d6+1 or spell (DC 11)
5	Ash slaves (2-8) — AC 13; HP 13; Atk +3 for 1d6+1
6	Corprus stalker — AC 14; HP 22; Atk +4 for 1d8+2; DC 12 Con or disease

1. Wooden Stairs

The stairs descend into darkness, their wooden planks slick with moisture and what might be blood. The air grows colder with each step, and you begin to hear a faint, rhythmic thrumming—like a heartbeat, but wrong, too slow and too deep.

Treacherous stairs: DC 12 Dex or slip, tumbling 60' to bottom. Fall alerts guards in room 2 (guards have surprise).

2. Entry Room

The stairs open into a wide chamber of packed earth and rough stone. Four figures stand at attention, their eyes glassy and unfocused. They wear the tattered remnants of what might have once been fine robes, now stained with ash and age. They do not speak, but one of them turns its head slowly to regard you—and a thin, unsettling smile spreads across its face.

4 Dreamer Cultists (CR 1/4 each). If party fell, cultists have advantage on initiative.

Dreamer Cultist (4): AC 12; HP 9; Atk 1x +3 for (1d6+1) or spell (DC 11); immune to sleep/frightened

Treasure: Each wears pewter Sixth House amulet (5 gp each).

3. Chamber of the Dreamer

Door swollen: DC 12 Str to open.

This room is filled with a thick, pungent smoke that stings your eyes and throat. In the center of the chamber, a brazier of black iron burns with an eerie green flame. Figures kneel around it—six of them, swaying slightly as if in a trance. One of them, an old Dark Elf with sunken eyes, turns to face you. His mouth opens, but the voice that emerges is not his own.

"The Sleeper has seen you coming. You are... welcome. Prove yourself thief or murderer and you will be made unwelcome."

6 Dreamer Cultists (CR 1/4) in trance. **1 Dreamer Priest** (CR 1) leads. DC 14 Stealth to surprise; otherwise priest casts *command* ("Kneel") on armored character.

Dreamer Priest: AC 13; HP 22; Atk +4 for 1d6+2 or spell (DC 12); spells: *command*, *bane*, *inflict wounds*, *hold person*

Treasure: Brazier worth 50 gp; priest's silver ring 25 gp; iron box under altar: 47 gp + *scroll of protection from evil and good*.

4. Cult Treasure Chamber

The ceiling of this chamber is 8' above the floor. Three large chests rest upon a raised platform of stone and packed earth in the center of the room. The air here smells of dust and old coin. As you enter, you notice that the shadows in the corners seem to lean inward, watching.

Chests locked (DC 13 pick), not trapped.

- **Chest 1:** 1,207 gp
- **Chest 2:** 456 gp + 45 gp mixed

- **Chest 3:** 87 ornamental stones (10 gp avg) + 6 semi-precious (25 gp avg)

Curse: Taking more than equal share: DC 14 Wis save or *dream vision* — disadvantage on Perception for 1d4 hours.

5. Cave-in

> *The west wall of the tunnel has collapsed here, burying the supporting timbers under tons of ash and mud. The rubble has created a small cavern, and the floor is covered in a layer of gray ash at least 3′ deep. Something seems to be moving beneath the surface.*

Movement: Half speed. Moving faster triggers collapse: DC 12 Dex or 1d6 bludgeoning.

Search (DC 15 Perception): Corpse with tarnished silver ring (15 gp), broken shortsword, Daedric journal (hints at hidden cache).

6. Burial Pool

Door swollen: DC 12 Str to open.

> *Beyond the door is a chamber almost entirely filled with a murky pool of dark water. The smell of ash and something fouler hangs heavy in the air. A thick, slime-covered column rises from the center of the pool to support the sagging timbers of the ceiling. Across the chamber, a small, muddy shelf extends into the pool.*
>
> *The water is still. Too still. You realize it's not water at all—it's ash, mixed with something dark and thick.*

A swarm of ash slaughterfish hiding in ash-water. Attack anyone entering.

> **Slaughterfish Swarm:** AC 13; HP 28; Atk 1x +5 for 1d6+5 or just 1d6 if the swarm is bloodied

Pool: 3′ deep + 1′ ash bottom = half speed. DC 12 Con or nauseated (disadvantage on attacks) 1 min.

Search (DC 15 Perception): Skeleton clutching small iron key (fits chest in room 18).

Secret Door (DC 15 Perception, elves advantage): Plug of ash/dirt leads to room 8 (2 turns to dig through).

7. Home of the Corprus Stalker

1 Corprus Stalker buried in mud.

> **Corprus Stalker:** AC 14; HP 22; Atk +4 for 1d8+2; DC 12 Con or wasting disease

Surprise: If walking through mud, stalker has advantage on first attack.

Door beyond is false — painted, leads nowhere.

8. Dreamer Cultists' Rooms

Lit by eerie green torches. Loud noises bring all cultists in 1-4 rounds.

8a — 4 cultists in trance. Disadvantage first round. No treasure.

8b — Locked (DC 12 pick). Empty. Dream journal with cryptic ramblings.

8c — Locked (DC 12 pick). 4 sleeping cultists. Weapons nearby, no armor. Incapacitated + surprised first round.

8d — Same as 8c. 4 sleeping cultists.

8e — Mess hall. Oven, dirty dishes, supplies. Nothing of value.

> **Dreamer Cultist (all):** AC 12; HP 9; Atk +3 for 1d6+1 or spell

9. Storage Room

Locked (DC 14 pick). Supplies: spears (10), daggers (4), shortsword, dried food, tools, torches.

Hidden (DC 15 Investigation): *Potion of healing* + 25 gp.

10. Empty Pool

> *This shallow pool of clear, still water was revealed when a section of the tunnel wall collapsed. Hundreds of pale, eyeless fish dart through the water—they seem to have no natural predators here. The water is cold and strangely pure compared to the ash-choked air.*

Water safe to drink. **Hidden shrine to Almalexia** (DC 12 Perception): drinking + praying grants *bless* for 1 hour.

11. Alcohol Storage

Stoutly locked (DC 15 pick). Forcing door (DC 17 Str): collapse deals 1d6 bludgeoning (DC 13 Dex half).

15 casks: cheap sujamma/mazte. 4 special casks: 2 dark mazte (100 gp each), 2 Fireamber Special Sujamma (200 gp each). Casks weigh 250 gp each.

12a-12b. Empty Rooms

Doors stuck (DC 10 Str to open). Nothing of value.

13. Entry Hall

> *This lofty room has a ceiling 15′ above the floor, supported by six stout columns of unadorned wood. A pool of ash and mud in the center of the floor reduces movement. Strange symbols are carved into the columns —they seem to writhe in the corner of your eye, but hold still when you look at them directly.*

Ash pool: half movement. **Daedric symbols (DC 15 Arcana):** praises to Dagoth Ur.

14. Lieutenants′ Quarters

Outer door heavily barred (DC 17 Str to force). Houses 2 assassins, 1 warrior, 1 priest (priest elsewhere).

> **Ranvek Sarano (Warrior):** AC 16; HP 30; Atk 2x +5 for 1d8+3; Str 16

> **Kyran Ethas (Assassin):** AC 15; HP 22; Atk 2x +5 for 1d6+3; sneak attack 2d6; Dex 17

> **Morag Aran (Assassin):** AC 14; HP 22; Atk +5 for 1d6+3 or crossbow 1d8+3; sneak attack 2d6; Dex 16

14a — Sitting room. Fireplace, sujamma keg, disturbing sketches.

14b — Kyran/Morag's room. 2 beds, chairs, cloaks. Hidden (DC 12): 45 gp under mattress.

14c — Ranvek's room. Bed, chair, quilt. *Potion of healing* under quilt.

14d — Locked (DC 15 pick). Priest's room. Bed, desk, chest. Obsidian Ascended Sleeper statue. Chest: Locked (DC 14 pick). *Glyph of warding* — paralyzes for 1d4 hours (DC 13 Con). Code word: "Sleep." Contents: dark robe, dark mace that can cast *inflict wounds* (x2 charges).

15. Ash Pool

This large room has no doors; the corridors simply end at the edge of a vast pool of dark, ash-choked water. While very shallow around its perimeter, the pool reaches a depth of 4' in the center. The muck on the bottom reduces movement to half speed. A stagnant, musty smell is strong here. The water is dark and still, and you can see shapes moving beneath the surface.

3 Dreugh resting on mud shelf. Attack if disturbed.

> **Dreugh (3):** AC 17; HP 40; Atk 2x +4 for 1d6+2; can grapple (escape DC 14)

Search (DC 16 Investigation): Skeleton with *ring of swimming* (advantage on Athletics swimming checks).

15a. Hidden Boat — Small boat holds 10. Dreugh won't attack if undisturbed.

16. Arched Chamber

Door unlocked, scorched with Sixth House symbol. 4 columns, 25' high ceiling.

Ash Ghoul (room 17) senses entry. **DC 14 Wis save** or *confusion* for 1 minute. Will attempt to convince the party to join the cult.

> **Ash Ghoul:** AC 16; HP 45; Atk 2x +6 for 1d6+3 psychic; DC 14 Wis or frightened 1 round; resistant to non-magical weapons

Retreats to room 17 at half health.

17. Den of the Ash Ghoul

This chamber is much like chamber 16, except that the four columns have been carved with disturbing murals of sleeping figures. The ascended dreamer's lair is here —the walls are lined with the belongings of those it has killed. Jewelry, weapons, and personal effects hang from hooks on the walls.

Treasure: Jewelry (250 gp, 100 gp x2, 90 gp, 75 gp, 50 gp x4); ruby pendant (800 gp); *ring of feather falling*; *dark steel wand of magic missiles* (7 charges - max).

Exit: Hole in ceiling leads to marsh above (unreachable by climbing).

18. Lair of the Corprus Stalker

Watery corridor (2' deep, half speed). If not encountered as wandering monster, **1 Corprus Stalker** here attacks.

> **Corprus Stalker:** AC 14; HP 22; Atk +4 for 1d8+2; DC 12 Con or wasting disease

Buried in mud: 300 gp + 80 sp (10% found

per turn searching).

19. Corridor

Watery hall, dead end.

20. Ash Slave Guardroom

Guards access to lower level. Doors barred (DC 15 Str to force).

20a — 2 Ash Slaves with stone clubs. If alerted, one bangs door to alert 4 more Ash Slaves (arrive in 2 rounds).

20b — Empty room.

20c — Guard resting area. Bones scattered, low table.

> **Ash Slave (all):** AC 13; HP 13; Atk +3 for 1d6+1; immune poison/disease

Total coins on all 6 ash slaves: 30 gp.

Dungeon Level 2

Walls irregular and winding. Water trickles. Smells of ash, decay, and metal.

Wandering Monsters: Whenever the DM desires them.

Roll	Encounter
1	Ash slaves (3-6)
2	Dreamer cultists (2-6)
3	Shalk Beetles (2-6)
4	Corprus stalkers (1-3)
5	Ancestor shadows (2-4) — AC 12; HP 27; Atk +4 for 1d6+2 necrotic; resist non-magical
6	Ash ghoul (1)

21. Ash Cavern

Two large columns support the roof in this large room, and the floor is coated with ash. A strange, rhythmic pulsing seems to emanate from the walls themselves.

Ash = half movement. Stepping stones allow single-file normal speed.

DC 14 Perception: Faint whispers from walls — "the coming dream," "the Sleeper's awakening."

22. Spider's Ambush

This appears to be nothing more than an empty, ash-filled room. The adventurer who steps in will quickly learn otherwise.

1 Ash Spider hiding. Surprise on 1-4 on d6 (visible if light source).

Ash Spider: CR 1 AC/DC 14 HP 30 Atk/Prof +5 Atks 1× (3d6 + 4)

Web (Recharge 5-6) - DC 13 Dex Save: one creature the spider can see within 60 feet. *Failure:* The target has the Restrained condition until the web is destroyed (AC 10; HP 5; Vulnerability to Fire damage; Immunity to Poison and Psychic damage).

No Treasure

23. Second Treasure Room

From the entrance, this large room appears to be filled with a pool of murky brown water. Actually, hidden around a bend in the wall is a shelf of dry earth and the cult's second treasure stash.

Secret door (plastered with ash): DC 12 Str to pry open. Small boat inside (holds 2 characters or 1 + ~2,500 gp weight).

2 chests on raised platform. Locked (DC 14 pick).

- **Chest 1 (trapped):** Poison needle on failed pick (DC 13 to remove). 2d6 poison (DC 14 Con half). Contents: 3700 gp.
- **Chest 2:** 300 gp, jeweled bracelet (1,000 gp), 20 small gems (25 gp each).

24. Chamber of the Ash Ghost

Door swollen: DC 12 Str to open.

There is a thick column in the center of the room, and the smell of death permeates the air. Behind the pillar, a spectral figure hovers—it resembles a Dark Elf, but its features are blurred and distorted.

Ash Ghost (specter variant: vulnerable to lightning).

Ash Ghost: AC 12; HP 22; Atk +4 for 1d6+2 necrotic; reduces max HP by same amount until long rest; resistant non-magical; immune charm/exhaustion/paralyzed/poison/unconscious

Lightning attacks cause disadvantage on next attack. North door locked (DC 14 pick).

25. Cells of the Doomed

Door locked (DC 14 pick). 5 cells:

Cell 1 — Sedyni Daras (if not rescued from temple) **Cell 2 —** Balmora merchant + farmer from east of Seyda Neen

Prisoners tell all they know about room 37. Won't fight.

26. Dreamer's Workshop

> *This room is bare except for five stone tables about 3' off the floor. Strange tools lie on the tables—knives, chisels, and other implements you cannot identify. The air is cold, and you feel a deep sense of unease.*

Ritual room for creating ash slaves. Currently empty.

27. Altar of the Sleeper

Door unlocked. The **Ash Vampire Ulath** (priest) is aware and prepared.

> *This is a long room whose walls are covered in wooden panels carved with disturbing symbols. At the far end is a raised dais with an altar supporting a statue of the Ascended Sleeper—a grotesque tentacled humanoid figure with many holes where their face ought to be. Next to the altar stands a Dark Elf in stained robes. A shadowy form stirs behind the statue.*

Ulath (CR 3 priest): AC 16 (chain mail + shield); spells include *bane*, *hold person*, *animate dead*, *bestow curse*. Carries keys to rooms 24, 25, and chests in 4 and 23.

> **Ulath:** AC 16; HP 40; Atk 2x +6 for 1d6+3; DC 14 evil spells

Ash Zombie assistant.

> Ash Zombie: CR 1/2 AC/DC 12 HP 22 (17-28) Atk/Prof +4 Atks 1× (1d6 + 2)
>
> **Corprus Stench -- Bonus Action** *Constitution Saving Throw*: DC 12 Any creature within 5-feet of the beast must save or. *Failure:* The target has the Poisoned condition until the start of its next turn. *Success:* The target is immune to this beast's Stench for 24 hours.

Ulath casts *bane* first, then *hold person* on caster.

Secret passage: Rotate statue's head to drop wooden panel revealing passage to room 37 (indetectable until head moved).

Treasure: Statue base compartment (DC 15 Investigation): 120 gp + *amulet of almalexia with one charge of both remove curse and bestow curse*.

28. Scrib Colony

> *This open area is choked with ash and mud.*

Ash = half movement. **9 Ash Scribs** mostly ignore the party unless provoked.

> **Scrib (9):** AC 13; HP 4; Atk +4 for 1d6+1;

No treasure.

29. Pumproom

> *The passage slants downward—small rivulets of water trickle into the darkness. Creaking and splashing noises echo from further along the passage.*

5 Ash Slaves operating bucket pulley. Ignore party unless attacked.

> **Ash Slave (5):** AC 13; HP 13; Atk +3 for 1d6+1

30. Ash Trap

> *This dank and dingy chamber contains a small chest upon a raised wooden platform.*

Chest bolted, not movable. **Trap:** Opening triggers ceiling collapse. DC 14 Dex or 1d6 bludgeoning + prone. Fail by 5+: pinned, suffocating.

Rescue: DC 15 Str, 1 round each. After 2 rounds, escape chance decreases 10%/round.

31. Empty Cave

Bones, faint rot smell. Empty.

32. Empty Cave

Dripping walls. Can hear water from room 29. Nothing.

33. Kwama Egg Nursery

Foul stench. Guards at both entrances.

2 Ash Slaves retreat to join 5 more. **Total 7 Ash Slaves** defend ash spawning pits. Surprise on 1-4 on d6.

One throws wicker cage releasing **1 Corprus Stalker** (attacks same round).

> **Ash Slave (7):** AC 13; HP 13; Atk +3 for 1d6+1

Treasure (DC 15 Perception): Buried sacks in northwest corner — 750 gp, gems (350 gp, 200 gp, 100 gp).

34. Kwama Egg Hatchery Part One

> *This chamber contains nearly 1,000 eggs—some beginning to crack open. None of the creatures inside has emerged yet, but they will be swarming forth in a short time. The eggs pulse with a faint, sickly light.*

Eggs will die if dungeon flooded. The cult is trying to start a kwama mine here to cover their nefarious operation.

35. Kwama Egg Hatchery Part Two

> *This chamber contains nearly 1,000 eggs—some beginning to crack open. None of the creatures inside has emerged yet, but they will be swarming forth in a short time. The eggs pulse with a faint, sickly light.*

Eggs will die if dungeon flooded. The cult is trying to start a kwama mine here to cover their nefarious operation.

36. Ash Beast's Lair

This small chamber holds a horrific creature —a twisted amalgamation of flesh and ash, resembling a massive beast with too many limbs. It is chained to the north wall and looks as if it can't come closer than 5' to the south wall. Disturbingly human bones are scattered about, and four skulls have been driven into the dirt walls.

Ash Beast (owlbear variant): resistance fire, vulnerability radiant.

Ash Beast: AC 13; HP 39; Atk 2x +6 for 1d8+3; resistance fire; vulnerability radiant

Chained to north wall (can't reach south wall). Purpose: noise warns Ascended Sleeper.

37. Throne Room of the Ascended Sleeper

This huge cavern is lit by a ghostly green glow emanating from the eight columns supporting the vaulted ceiling. A large flatbottomed boat sits at the shore of a pool of dark water before you. The pool seems to occupy most of the cavern.

Boat: Holds 10, 20 ft/round with pole.

If the party crosses the water, read below.

As you cross the pool here, you see around the corner to your right, there is a raised dais. On it, something waits. It is tall, humanoid, and utterly wrong. Its face is a expanse of flesh with too many holes and tentacles erupting. It's body cloaked in a robe with all too elvish and too small hands. It has no eyes, yet you feel it watching you. Suddenly, a fireball streaks through the air towards you.

Ascended Sleeper (Boss) awaits.

Ascended Sleeper (Boss): AC 17; HP 85; Atk 3x +7 for 1d8+4 psychic **Special:**

- **Nightmare Gaze:** Start of party's turn, one creature within 30' — DC 15 Wis or frightened until start of next turn
- **Dream Eater (Recharge 5-6):** One target within 60' — DC 15 Cha or 4d8 psychic + it takes a **bonus turn** where it is controlled by the sleeper
- **Incorporeal Movement:** Moves through creatures/objects as difficult terrain; 1d10 force if ends turn inside object
- **Resistant:** Non-magical damage
- **Immunities:** Psychic, poison, charm, frightened

Strategy: Uses incorporeal movement to avoid melee. Focuses psychic damage on casters/support. At 25 HP or less, attempts escape through secret passage behind dais.

Treasure coffers around the dais:

- 20,000 gp - most of the wealth of Seyda Neen cultists
- *Bag of holding*, *boots of elvenkind*, *horn of blasting*
- *Ring of confusion 2x charges, ring of free action*
- Potions: *gaseous form*, *invisibility*, *growth*, *clairvoyance*, 2x *greater healing*

2 ivory scroll tubes (DC 15 Dex to open; break = 1d8 force 10' radius, DC 13 Dex half). Each tube worth 400 gp intact. Spells can be cast from the scrolls but must be recharged before they can be cast again. Recharging the scrolls costs 100 gp worth of gems per spell level.

- **Scroll 1:** *slow*, *stinking cloud*, *detect magic*, *arcane lock*, *identify*
- **Scroll 2:** *dispel magic*, *blink*, *fear*, *glyph of warding*

Aftermath

Sleeper destroyed: All charmed/corrupted humanoids freed (vague dreamlike memories). Ash creatures and corprus stalkers remain hostile.